

Wansoo Choi

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EDUCATION

University at Buffalo, Buffalo, New York 2021 – 2027 (expected)
PhD Candidate in Finance, School of Management

Johns Hopkins University, Washington, DC 2019
Master of Science in Applied Economics

University at Albany, Albany, New York 2017
Bachelor of Science in Business Administration (Financial Analyst Honors Program)
Undergraduate Honors Thesis: “The Impact of Leverage on Hedge Fund Performance”

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Market Microstructure, Informed Trading, Retail Trading, Hedge Fund Activism, Options

WORKING PAPERS

Assessing the Reliability of Retail Trade Classification: Evidence from the Tick Size Pilot
Job Market Paper [SSRN]

Abstract: Widely used retail classification algorithms assume off-exchange sub-tick executions are retail orders. Because tick sizes restrict quotes but not trades, this assumption is difficult to verify. The SEC’s Tick Size Pilot provides an exception: it restricted Group 2 trades to the five-cent grid but exempted retail, making remaining sub-tick executions a retail benchmark. Relative to Group 2, difference-in-differences identifies excess off-exchange retail-classified shares as false positives, yielding 7.6 percentage points in quote-constrained Group 1 and 10.4 in Control. Implied false discovery rates are 55.8% and 57.2%. Quote-midpoint classification reduces, but does not eliminate, contamination. On-exchange classifications show no corresponding excess.

Presentations: SFA 2026 (scheduled), EasternFA 2026, SWFA 2026, University at Buffalo 2025

Market Quality of Informed Trades [SSRN]

with Juha Joenväärä, Dominik Rösch, and Cristian Tiu

Abstract: We investigate prices around timestamped informed trades using approximately 500,000 13D transactions from activist investors matched to TAQ trades. Activists are more price sensitive than non-activists and are more likely to attempt to hide their trading by strategically choosing when and how to trade. Activists have higher execution quality, but also higher price impact and lower realized spreads, suggesting that activists, on average, fail to hide among the uninformed. Activists with less information (as measured by lower returns) are better at hiding (that is, they have better execution quality). These results are reversed for hedge funds: hedge funds with better execution quality generate higher returns.

Presentations: University of Chicago, Department of Economics 2026 (scheduled), SFA 2026 (scheduled), FMA 2026 (scheduled), NFA 2026 (scheduled), AsianFA 2026, EasternFA 2026, SWFA 2026*, Annual Hedge Fund Research Conference 2026 (Poster), University of Melbourne 2025*, CFEA 2025, Hanyang University 2025*, University at Buffalo 2024 – 2025

*Presented by co-authors

How to: Dynamic Reports and Reproducible Research [SSRN]

with Toghrol Aghbabali, Taihun Im, Dominik Rösch, and Prince Roy

Abstract: We propose a framework to generate dynamic reports and make reproducible research easier. Motivated by growing concerns about the lack of reproducibility and replicability, nowadays, most journals ask authors to post their programming code. While beneficial to others, these policies seem costly to the original authors. Using a combination of freely available tools, we illustrate our framework with a case study in asset pricing. We demonstrate how research can be conducted with replicability in mind, significantly lowering costs and increasing benefits for the original authors.

WORK IN PROGRESS

What Do Options Know About Firm-Specific News?

with Dominik Rösch and Avaniidhar Subrahmanyam

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

Presentations

- **2026:** University of Chicago, Department of Economics (scheduled), Southern Finance Association (scheduled), Financial Management Association (scheduled), Northern Finance Association (scheduled), Asian Finance Association, Southwestern Finance Association, Eastern Finance Association, Annual Hedge Fund Research Conference (Poster)
- **2025:** Conference on Financial Economics and Accounting, University at Buffalo Celebration of Student Excellence, University at Buffalo School of Management Brown Bag, University at Buffalo School of Management PhD Showcase
- **2024:** University at Buffalo School of Management PhD Showcase, University at Buffalo Institute for Artificial Intelligence and Data Science

Discussions

- **2026:** Southern Finance Association (scheduled), Financial Management Association (scheduled), Asian Finance Association, Eastern Finance Association

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, MGF 402 Investment Management, University at Buffalo Spring 2026

- Taught undergraduate Investment Management, covering core topics in asset pricing, portfolio theory, and derivatives.
- Designed a stock valuation project covering cost of equity, cost of debt, and equity valuation.
- Received an overall instructor rating of 4.3/5.0 with an 85% response rate.

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

- GSEU Professional Development Award, Travel Grant (University at Buffalo) June 2026
- Frank L. Ciminelli Family Fund (University at Buffalo) March 2026
- E. Han Kim Doctoral Fellowship (University at Buffalo) November 2025
- Dr. Robert F. Berner Doctoral Fund (University at Buffalo) November 2025
- Joseph A. Alutto Fellowship (University at Buffalo) 2021 – 2025
- Alumni of Professor Ronald Forbes Scholarship (University at Albany) November 2016

WORK EXPERIENCE

Republic of Korea Army – Sergeant, Incheon, South Korea 2012 – 2014
Intelligence (S2)

Oxford University Press Seoul Branch – Marketing Assistant, Seoul, South Korea 2012

TECHNICAL / LANGUAGE SKILLS

Programming: R, SQL, Python, SAS, Stata, MATLAB

Tools: L^AT_EX, OneTick, Microsoft Office

Language: English (Fluent), Korean (Native)

REFERENCES

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